



IELTS Listening Practice Test

Transcript — Parts 1–4 · Episode 13

PART 1

A customer calls a local community center to book a place on an upcoming outdoor activity. You now have some time to look at questions 1 to 10.

Speaker B: Good morning, Oakridge Community Outdoors. Thomas speaking. How can I help you today?

Speaker A: Hello! I'm calling to book a spot on the weekend photography workshop I saw advertised. My name is Clara Vance.

Speaker B: Great to hear, Clara. Let me get some details from you. First, is that Vance spelled V-A-N-C-E?

Speaker A: Yes, that's correct.

Speaker B: Perfect. Now, which date were you hoping to join us? We have workshops running on several Saturdays in September.

Speaker A: I was hoping for the one on the eighteenth of September.

Speaker B: Let me just check the booking system for the eighteenth... Ah, I'm afraid that particular session is completely full. We do have spaces left on the following weekend, the twenty-fifth of September. Would that work for you?

Speaker A: Oh, let me think. Yes, actually, the twenty-fifth is fine. Let's go with that.

Speaker B: Wonderful, I've put you down for the twenty-fifth of September. Next, I'll need a contact number for you in case there are any weather-related changes on the day.

Speaker A: Of course. My mobile number is 0-7-7-0-0-9-5-4-3-2-1.

Speaker B: Let me repeat that back to make sure I've got it: 0-7-7-0-0-9-5-4-3-2-1.

Speaker A: That's spot on.

Speaker B: Great. Now, the instructor likes to know a bit about the participants beforehand. What would you say your current photography experience level is? Beginner, intermediate, or advanced?

Speaker A: I've been taking photos for a couple of years and understand the basic settings, so I'd say I'm an intermediate. I'm hoping to move beyond automatic mode.



Speaker B: Excellent, the intermediate group is perfect for that. Is there any specific subject you'd like to focus on during the outdoor shoot?

Speaker A: I mostly do landscape photos, but I really want to learn how to capture birds. They move so quickly, and I always struggle to get a sharp image.

Speaker B: Our instructor is an expert at wildlife photography, so you'll get plenty of tips on birds. Do you have all your own gear, or will you need to rent anything from us? We have cameras and lenses available.

Speaker A: I have my own camera and a decent zoom lens, but I don't own a tripod. It gets heavy carrying one on the train. Can I rent one?

Speaker B: Absolutely, we can reserve a sturdy tripod for you. There's no extra charge for that. Now, about the meeting point on the day. Usually, groups gather at the main gate of the park. Oh, wait, let me check the park schedule... Ah, actually, I need to correct that. Because of roadworks near the entrance, the instructor has changed the meeting point. You'll need to meet near the bridge, which is just a short walk from the car park.

Speaker A: Near the bridge. Got it. I'll make a note of that. And what is the total cost of the workshop?

Speaker B: The standard fee is ninety-five pounds, but since you are booking during our early-bird promotion, you get a ten-pound discount. So the total will be eighty-five pounds.

Speaker A: That's a great price.

Speaker B: I've processed that now. Your booking reference number is 8-4-9-2-0-1.

Speaker A: Let me write that down. Could you say it again slowly?

Speaker B: Sure, it is 8-4-9-2-0-1.

Speaker A: Thank you. I've got it.

Speaker B: Great. Just out of curiosity, how did you first hear about our workshops?

Speaker A: Well, I was browsing through some old photography magazines at the local library last week, and I saw your advertisement in one of them.

Speaker B: Ah, yes, we ran an ad in 'Shutter Speed' magazine recently. It's great to know people are seeing it. We look forward to seeing you on the twenty-fifth.

Speaker A: Thank you so much for your help. Goodbye!

Speaker B: Goodbye, Clara!

PART 2

You will hear a local community leader giving a talk about the recent renovations and new activities at Greenvale Park. You now have some time to look at questions 11 to 20.

Speaker A: Good evening, everyone, and thank you for coming to our monthly neighborhood association meeting. I'm delighted to share some wonderful news about the extensive renovations at Greenvale Park, which have finally been completed after six months of hard work. The park officially reopens to the public this Friday. First, I want to talk about the changes we've made to the children's play area. Previously, it was mostly just swings and a slide on a concrete surface, which wasn't very safe or exciting. We've completely redesigned this area using natural wood materials to create a forest-themed adventure playground. The ground is now covered in soft woodchips to prevent injuries. We've also added a brand-new climbing wall designed specifically for younger children, which we expect to be extremely popular. Another major upgrade is the community garden. Before the renovation, this was a neglected patch of grass behind the old tennis courts. Now, we have installed twenty raised vegetable beds. Residents can rent these beds for a small annual fee to grow their own organic produce. We've already had a huge amount of interest from local apartment residents who don't have their own gardens, and half of the beds have already been reserved. We also built a wooden greenhouse, which will be used for gardening workshops during the winter months. In addition to the garden, we have constructed a new fitness trail that loops around the entire perimeter of the park. It is exactly one point five kilometers long and features ten different exercise stations, including pull-up bars and balance beams. It is free to use at any time, and we hope it will encourage residents of all fitness levels to get active outdoors. We've also installed new LED lighting along this trail to ensure it's safe for runners in the early mornings and late evenings. Now, let's look at the park's opening hours. During the summer season, which runs from April to October, the gates will open at seven in the morning and close at nine in the evening. In the winter months, however, we have to adjust these times due to reduced daylight. From November to March, the park will still open at seven, but it will close earlier, at five in the afternoon. Please make sure to leave the park promptly before closing, as the gates will be locked automatically by our security system. Moving on to the cafe. The old kiosk has been replaced by a modern, environmentally-friendly cafe called 'The Green Leaf'. It will be run by a local family business and will focus on serving healthy snacks, homemade cakes, and organic coffee. All of their packaging is completely biodegradable, and they have committed to sourcing at least seventy percent of their ingredients from local farms. It will be open daily from eight in the morning until four in the afternoon. Finally, I'd like to tell you about some of the volunteer opportunities we have available. We are establishing a volunteer group called 'Friends of Greenvale'. The main task for this group will be the regular maintenance of the flowerbeds and the newly planted orchard.



Volunteers will meet every Saturday morning from nine until noon. You don't need any prior gardening experience to join, as our head gardener will provide all necessary training. It's a fantastic way to meet your neighbors, get some exercise, and contribute to our local environment. We will also be organizing monthly litter-picking events, which are great for families with children who want to get involved. If you are interested in volunteering, please visit our website and fill out the online registration form. We're also hosting a welcome barbecue for all volunteers next Saturday at noon, so please do sign up before then if you can make it.



PART 3

Two university students, Olivia and Liam, are discussing their upcoming group research project on green architecture with their tutor, Professor Jackson. You now have some time to look at questions 21 to 30.

Speaker B: Welcome, Olivia and Liam. Come on in. I wanted to check how your research project on green architecture in urban environments is progressing. The final proposal is due in two weeks.

Speaker A: Thanks, Professor Jackson. We've done a lot of reading, but we're struggling to narrow down our focus. There's just so much information on sustainable design.

Speaker C: Yes, initially we wanted to look at residential solar panels, but we realized that's been covered extensively in previous years. We want to do something more original.

Speaker B: That's a wise decision. What other areas have you considered?

Speaker A: Well, we looked at rainwater harvesting systems, but the engineering details got very complex. Then we started researching vertical gardens, or 'living walls', on high-rise office buildings. We found some fascinating studies on how they reduce energy consumption by keeping buildings cool.

Speaker B: Living walls are a highly relevant topic. There is a lot of new data available on their thermal performance. I'd highly recommend focusing on that.

Speaker C: Great, let's make that our main topic, Olivia. Now, regarding the case studies for our project, we need to choose three buildings to analyze. We were thinking about the Pixel Building in Melbourne, the Bosco Verticale in Milan, and the Tower of Fruit in Singapore.

Speaker B: Those are excellent choices, but remember you need to compare specific aspects, such as maintenance costs, irrigation methods, and local climate adaptation. Let's talk about how you plan to divide the tasks. Have you agreed on your roles?

Speaker A: Yes, we've split the workload. Liam is going to handle the data collection regarding energy efficiency metrics, since he's great with spreadsheets.

Speaker C: And Olivia is going to draft the literature review because she has a real talent for synthesizing academic papers. She'll also design the slides for our final presentation.

Speaker B: That sounds like a fair division of labor. Now, you also need to conduct some primary research. How do you plan to gather your own data?

Speaker A: We were planning to send out an online survey to local architects to ask about their experiences with designing living walls.

Speaker B: Surveys can be useful, but architects are busy people and your response rate might be very low. What about conducting a few semi-structured interviews instead? You only need three or four participants to get deep, qualitative insights.

Speaker C: That makes sense. We actually know two local architects who worked on the green roof project downtown. I'm sure they would agree to a fifteen-minute interview.

Speaker B: Excellent. Now, let's look at your schedule. Have you set milestones for the next two weeks?

Speaker A: Yes, we want to finish the interviews by this Friday. Then, we plan to spend the weekend analyzing the transcripts.

Speaker C: We hope to have the first draft of the report completed by next Tuesday, which gives us three days for editing before the submission deadline on Friday.

Speaker B: Your timeline seems realistic. Now, let's discuss the different green buildings you are analyzing and what specific features you will focus on for each.

Speaker A: Yes, let's start with the Pixel Building in Melbourne. What struck us most was its innovative water recycling system, which filters graywater through rooftop planters.

Speaker C: Exactly, but for our analysis, we should probably focus on its double-glazed smart windows, which automatically adjust to block out heat.

Speaker B: Actually, the most unique feature of the Pixel Building is its carbon-neutral concrete. It was the first building in Australia to achieve a perfect environmental score because of that material choice. You should definitely focus on that.

Speaker A: Oh, I didn't realize that. We'll definitely change our focus to the concrete then.

Speaker C: What about the Bosco Verticale in Milan? The sheer scale of the trees planted on the balconies is amazing.

Speaker B: It is indeed. For that building, you should look closely at its irrigation system. They use recycled graywater, but the key is how they distribute it using a gravity-fed network to hundreds of separate balconies.

Speaker A: That sounds fascinating. And finally, the Tower of Fruit in Singapore.

Speaker B: Ah, that building is famous for its natural ventilation design, which eliminates the need for air conditioning in the public corridors. It uses wind scoops to channel drafts through the center of the structure.

Speaker C: What about the Eco-Dome in London? I read that they use a unique solar shading system.



Speaker B: Yes, their smart blinds adjust automatically based on the sun's position. But for your project, look at their triple-glazed roof, which is constructed entirely of lightweight polymer instead of glass.

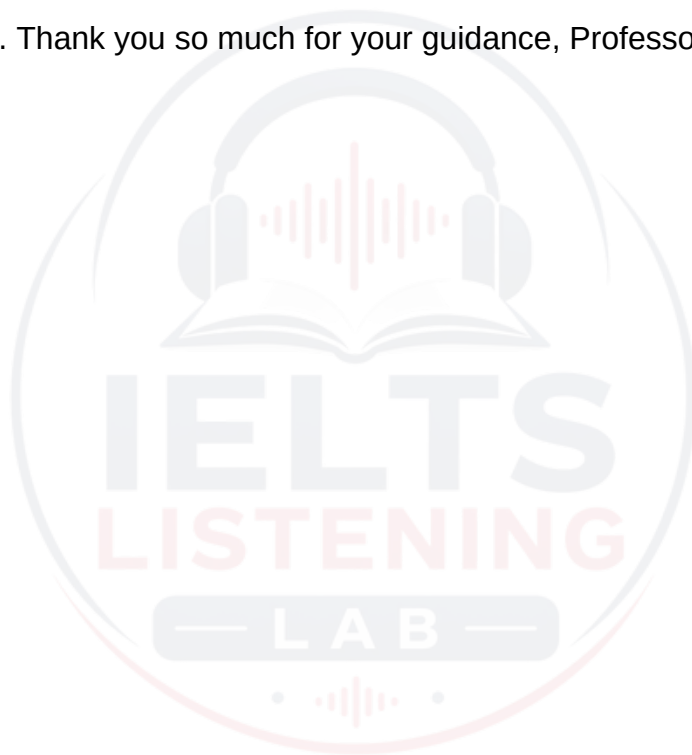
Speaker A: Interesting. And the Sun-Tower in Tokyo?

Speaker B: Its most outstanding feature is the geothermal heat pump, which utilizes underground heat to regulate the building's temperature year-round.

Speaker C: That will be highly relevant for our climate adaptation section.

Speaker B: Excellent. I think you have a very solid plan here. Keep me updated on your interview progress.

Speaker A: We will. Thank you so much for your guidance, Professor!



PART 4

You will hear a lecture by an oceanographer about the history of deep-sea exploration and the historic dive of the bathyscaphe Trieste. You now have some time to look at questions 31 to 40.

Speaker A: Good morning, everyone. In today's marine history lecture, we are going to explore the remarkable story of the bathyscaphe Trieste, the deep-sea submersible that made history on January twenty-third, nineteen sixty, by reaching the deepest known point of the Earth's oceans: the Challenger Deep in the Mariana Trench. To understand this achievement, we must first look at the challenges of deep-sea descent. The primary obstacle is, of course, hydrostatic pressure. At the bottom of the Mariana Trench, the pressure is over one thousand times greater than at sea level. Early diving spheres, known as bathyspheres, were suspended from a ship by a steel cable. This design was highly dangerous because if the cable snapped, the crew would be lost. Furthermore, the weight of a long cable itself became a limiting factor. To overcome these limitations, a Swiss physicist named Auguste Piccard invented the bathyscaphe in the late nineteen forties. Unlike the bathysphere, a bathyscaphe was a free-diving vessel, meaning it was not attached to a ship by any cable. It operated much like a hot air balloon, but in water instead of air. To float, it used a large float chamber filled with gasoline, which is lighter than water and highly incompressible under pressure. To sink, the vessel used heavy iron ballast, which was held in place by electromagnets. This was a brilliant safety feature: if the electricity failed, the magnets would lose power, the ballast would automatically drop, and the vessel would float back to the surface. The Trieste was purchased by the United States Navy in nineteen fifty-eight. Under their sponsorship, a series of test dives were conducted off the coast of Guam. The ultimate goal was to reach the absolute bottom of the ocean. On the historic day of the dive, January twenty-third, nineteen sixty, the Trieste was manned by Auguste Piccard's son, Jacques Piccard, and Lieutenant Don Walsh of the US Navy. The descent took nearly five hours. As they went deeper, the temperature inside the tiny steel cabin dropped significantly, eventually reaching just seven degrees Celsius. The crew had to wear dry clothing and eat chocolate bars to stay warm. At a depth of around nine thousand meters, a sudden, loud cracking sound startled the crew. It was later discovered that one of the outer plexiglass windowpanes had cracked due to the extreme cold, though thankfully the inner pane held and the cabin remained sealed. When the Trieste finally touched down on the ocean floor at approximately ten thousand nine hundred and sixteen meters, the impact stirred up a thick cloud of silt, which completely blocked their vision. It took about twenty minutes for the water to clear. During their twenty minutes on the seabed, the crew made a groundbreaking scientific discovery. Despite the absolute darkness and crushing pressure, they observed a flatfish, which Piccard described as resembling a sole. This discovery proved once and for all that marine life could survive at the very bottom of the ocean, which revolutionized our understanding of

deep-sea biology. The successful voyage of the Trieste demonstrated that humans could safely visit the deepest parts of our planet. However, it would be another fifty-two years before another manned vessel returned to the Challenger Deep, a testament to the immense technical difficulties of deep-sea exploration.

